

ones like the desktop, it goes as high as 63% of the market. But as they say, Ch(rome) wasn't built in a day. In fact, before development could be started, Eric Schmidt had been opposing the idea of a browser from Google for more than six years – in order to steer clear of the so called 'browser wars'. But after co-founders Sergey Brin and Larry Page persisted by hiring a bunch of Mozilla devs and building a demo, Schmidt's six year abstinence came to an end and Chrome was given a go-ahead. Long story short, Chrome went on to be so successful that Google now has an entire sub-brand of Chrome products such as Chromecast, Chromebook, Chromebit, Chromebox and Chromebase.

Officially launched in 2008 for Windows, within a couple of years Google launched stable versions for OS X and Linux as well. And within a couple of years from that, Google had launched Android 4.1 with Google Chrome pre installed. By the time Chrome 9 had launched in 2011, the browser supported features like WebGL, Chrome Instant and the Chrome Web Store.



One of the most important and identifying features in Google Chrome is the omnibox – essentially a merged address bar and search bar. This feature was eventually implemented in many other browsers. Omnibox is also where you experience Google Instant, which is what brings up suggestions for previously opened websites, popular websites, or even ways to search within a website when you type something into the omnibox.

The Chrome Web Store allows you to install applications on the web. While many have deemed this redundant as most such 'web apps' take you to a webpage anyway, Google has focussed increasingly on making these apps work offline and independent of the rest of the browser, making a case for the web-store's utility. Another concern for Chrome's Web Store is the security. Researchers have identified 50,870 Google Chrome extensions and 34,407 programs that injected ads. Thirty-eight percent of extensions and 17 percent of programs were catalogued as malware, the rest being potentially unwanted adware-type applications. And when you look at the growing adoption of Chrome OS as compared to the low-availability